

available English. Don't be too disheartened though: as the Web becomes more "Googlified," we hope you will be soon able to see Google News in your favourite language!

Meanwhile, recommend to Google your favourite regional language news sites by going to www.google.com/support/news/bin/request.py.

16.1 Anatomy Of A Google News Clip

The standard Google News homepage is divided into a number of topics headlined by Top Stories, followed by eight other topics or “standard sections” as they are called, which relate to the following subject areas: World, Nation (country-specific), Business, Sci/Tech, Sports, Entertainment, Health, and Most Popular.

The standard sections are customisable in a number of ways explained in more detail in the Personalisation section in chapter 7. Under each section, text clips from the leading stories are displayed.



The Google News home page



Your typical news clip

You search for news topics using keywords, much like you would on other Google sites. The results are displayed by relevance by default; they can also be sorted by date by clicking on the “Sort by date” link at the upper right corner. Also, all Google News search results can be distributed as an RSS feed (see §16.3 for details), the search keywords can be used to personalise your Google News homepage (see §16.2 for more), and the search keywords can also be used to create e-mail alerts (see Chapter 13 to learn how).

Each news clip displays a text snippet from the Web site of the highest ranked (by Google) news source. Clicking on the headline will take you directly to the Web site with the news story. Immediately below the text snippet, clickable headlines to the same story from the second- and third-ranked news Web site are displayed.

Below these are links to the other top sites containing the same story. Finally, below these links, you will find a link to *all* news articles on the same story. If you are on a slow connection, you can speed up the display somewhat by switching to the text-only version: click on the “Text Version” link in the left pane. You can control the display of text snippets and thumbnails plus lots more by using the customisation and personalisation features that Google News supports.